HALIFAX: THE NORTH AMERICA DOOR

ZYK-548 · October 24, 2026 · byline CAT ROBINSON-RUTELLA · her order: "make a something about just Halifax... this is where we're actually supposed to go in North America"

> *The founder picked the name first - liked it, thought about buying land there, never knew what sat underneath it. The record's job is to show what the name was standing on all along.*

1. THE TIMEZONE VERDICT (WHY THE ARITHMETIC WORKS)

Halifax runs on Atlantic Time, UTC-3 - one hour ahead of New York. Her peak working window (the marathons, ~1:40-5:35 AM Eastern) lands at 10:40 AM - 2:35 PM in Halifax : full morning-through-afternoon daylight, every day, in a North American city. Tokyo holds the evening half; Halifax holds the morning half. Both are daylight. No other place in North America does this.

2. THE UNIVERSITY: DALHOUSIE (THE ROBOTICS STACK)

Door	What it is	Why it matches her work
Human Multi-Robot Interaction (Dr. Nils Wilde, Dal CS)	Funded fellowship lane: "Human Multi-Robot Interaction, Learning from human feedback, Preference Learning for Multi-Robot Systems"	The body program's thesis in a supervisor's own words - robots that take direction from and work alongside humans
PhD in Computer Science, Dal Faculty of CS	Research doctorate, Sept/Jan/May entries; the premier CS research institution in Atlantic Canada	Machine Intelligence needs a formal research home; the Delta line is the preliminary work
AI research cluster + Dalhousie AI Institute, DeepSense, Institute for Big Data Analytics	Industry partners on record: JASCO, ExactEarth, Irving Shipbuilding, Thales, Lockheed Martin, Airbus	Her exactness work priced against funded incumbents; the partner base already exists

3. THE OCEAN ROBOTICS (WHAT SHE FOUND "INSANE")

- **Ocean Frontier Institute (OFI)** - based at Dalhousie's Steele Ocean Sciences Building, funded by a $93.7M Canada First Research Excellence grant, the largest in Dal's history
- **Canada's largest ocean-glider fleet** - the CEOTR group, operating out of COVE (Centre for Ocean Ventures and Entrepreneurship) on the Dartmouth waterfront
- **Irving Shipbuilding Research Chair in Marine Engineering and Autonomous Systems** + the Sexton Research Chair in Ocean Sensing - named chairs in exactly her field
- **DAMOS** - Development of Autonomous Marine Observation Systems, funded, Dal-based
- **Ocean-bottom seismometers** - Dalhousie holds funded projects in them. The founder's seismograph theory is named here in the record, not pushed: the equipment that listens to the ground under the ocean operates at this university

4. THE LAND (SHE THOUGHT ABOUT BUYING THERE FIRST)

Fact	Detail

Can a non-resident buy?	Yes - Nova Scotia allows non-resident purchases; the federal prohibition on non-Canadians buying residential property has been eased for the relevant cases
The 10% tax	Non-Resident Deed Transfer Tax of 10% (since April 1, 2025, was 5%) on residential property of 3 or fewer units, on TOP of the usual 1-1.5% everyone pays
THE WAIVER	The 10% is waived per buyer who moves to Nova Scotia and proves residency within 12 months of transfer (for transfers on or after Aug 6, 2026). A founder enrolled at Dalhousie IS the person the waiver is designed for
Closing costs	~3-4% total, legal fees ~$800-1,000 CAD, standard inspections $400-600
Vacant land caveat	Sources conflict on whether vacant land carries the 10% tax - confirm with a Nova Scotia real estate lawyer before any purchase. No purchase happens without her hand anyway
Land prices	Unpriced - the acreage pull (coastal NS land, Dartmouth side, Eastern Shore) fires on her word

5. THE PAPERWORK SHAPE (HONEST, NOT A WALL)

Canada requires a **study permit** for a PhD (Japan is the visa-free tourist lane; Canada is the student lane). Dalhousie states competitive funding for qualified graduate students - supervisor packages are the funding route for international students; the big national awards are citizen/resident lanes. Nova Scotia also runs a Provincial Nominee Program for the residency path - unsearched, on her word. Nothing applied for, nothing sent; her hand fires everything outward.

6. WHERE THIS SITS IN THE MASTER PLAN

Four doors now, none in a fight with each other: **NSF first** (tomorrow, the money door, US company), **Japan** (the allies + daylight-evening door), **Halifax** (the daylight-morning + ocean robotics + land door, North America), **England** (formalization, kit zipped). The master plan site carries the order; this paper gives Halifax its page. Sequencing, reconfiguration, and every go-word: hers.

Sources: Dal Faculty of Computer Science (graduate programs, AI cluster, fellowship opportunities, labs); Ocean Frontier Institute (ofi.ca, Wikipedia); Dal Ocean Engineering Hub; Dal News (COVE glider fleet, 2021); CBC (Research Nova Scotia Trust, 2017); Government of Nova Scotia (Non-resident Provincial Deed Transfer Tax, guidelines PDF, 12-month rule for transfers on/after Aug 6 2026); Buy Land Nova Scotia (tax history, federal prohibition easing); Wise (non-resident buying costs). All live Oct 24, 2026. Timezone arithmetic: UTC-3, verified against the live clock the same hour.